

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.12

HEALT0.17

COMM.0.27

CONS.0.30

MATER0.51

ENERG0.57

UTILI0.73

INDUS1.15

TECHN1.89

CONS.2.28

FINAN6.57

1

MU

BUY

\$974.33

+3.97%

8/10

Micron is the pure-play memory bet on the AI buildout — HBM (high-band)

2

NVDA

BUY

\$216.85

-0.33%

8/10

The AI infrastructure buildout is a multi-year federal + hyperscaler s

3

AMZN

BUY

\$260.11

-2.16%

7/10

Dominant cloud + retail machine navigating tariff refunds and AI capex

Big options bets on AMGN (Other) — 44.8x normal volume, P/C 0.03, largest: CALL \$400 (2543.0x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No major earnings this week

Consumer Confidence

Date: 2026-08-24

MEDIUM

VIX at 15.4 — low. Options m arket complacent ahead of sc heduled events.

Consumer Confidence [MEDIUM]

Consumer Confidence [MEDIUM]

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Here's what's interesting in the flow: big money is piling into Real Estate at a truly unusual clip — a put/call ratio of 0.12 with 4x normal volume is a screaming bet that rates are coming down, which lines up with the growing chorus in Washington pressuring the Fed to cut and the softening labor data giving them cover. Healthcare bullishness likely reflects the market pricing in that the worst of drug pricing and PBM legislation is either priced in or getting watered down in committee, while Comm Services and Consumer Discretionary calls suggest smart money still believes the consumer and the AI ad-spend cycle have another leg.

On the flip side, someone big is quietly hedging Technology and dumping premium on Financials — that 6.57 P/C on XLF combined with widening credit spreads and bearish HYG/LQD flow tells me institutions are worried about credit stress bleeding into bank balance sheets, possibly tied to CRE refinancing walls or tariff-driven earnings hits to regional lenders.

The contradiction worth noting: tech stocks keep grinding higher in the headlines while the options market is paying up for downside protection — that's classic late-cycle behavior where people ride the tape but buy insurance.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.91/100
Leidos combines defense IT services with a growing digital modern			
2.	MDB	MongoDB, Inc.	8.46/100
MongoDB's Atlas platform is emerging as a preferred vector databa			
3.	BAH	Booz Allen Hamilton Holding Co	8.53/100
Booz Allen is the go-to consultant for AI/ML deployment across th			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 9–10	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 17–18	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Hold \$311.30 ▼ 1.75% 12M Price Target \$330.00 52-Week Range \$224.69 – \$344.57 Market Cap \$4.54T

AAPL: Vision Pro Cuts Signal Pivot to Smart Glasses

WHAT HAPPENED

- Apple is laying off Vision Pro staff and shifting resources to smart glasses — this is basically an admission that the \$3,500 headset was a commercial dud. Not surprising, but it matters because it signals Apple is chasing Meta's Ray-Ban glasses playbook rather than defending its own moonshot. Reallocation of talent = good; sunk-cost fallacy would have been worse.
- CEO transition chatter (Ternus reportedly next in line to replace Tim Cook) is heating up. Markets hate succession uncertainty even when the successor is well-regarded — that's part of why the stock gave back 1.75% yesterday after Tuesday's pop.

WHY IT MATTERS

The options market is flashing yellow — a put/call ratio of 0.51 sounds bullish on the surface (more calls than puts), but the UNUSUAL put buying at \$315, \$330, and \$335 strikes tells you big money is buying downside protection right at current levels. That's someone with real capital hedging against a near-term drop. Combined with the insider selling from the General Counsel (routine, but still no insider buying anywhere) and the fact that AAPL is at 72% of its 52-week range, the risk/reward has gotten less attractive here. The bigger story: Apple is transitioning — new CEO likely coming, Vision Pro dead, foldable iPhone and smart glasses being the next big swings — and transitions create volatility even for the world's most stable mega-cap.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The single biggest political variable for Apple is US-China trade policy. Apple still assembles the majority of iPhones in China, and any tariff escalation or export control expansion hits margins directly — every 5% incremental tariff on Chinese electronics roughly costs Apple \$3-5B in gross profit unless they pass it to consumers (which hurts demand) or eat it. Also watch the DOJ antitrust case on the App Store — if courts force Apple to allow third-party payment processors, that 30% "Apple tax" on developers (worth ~\$25B/year in Services revenue) starts eroding. Friendlier angle: any US manufacturing incentive extensions could benefit Apple's growing India/Vietnam diversification and their Texas server plants for Apple Intelligence.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$311.30
12M Price Target	\$330.00
Upside / (Downside)	+6.0%
Market Cap	\$4.54T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.45
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	41.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$325.00	\$312.00	\$295.00
6 Months	\$355.00	\$320.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$380.00	\$330.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$365.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$280.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% over 5 days) — likely reflecting oil price strength and any geopolitical premium being priced in. Real Estate holding up as rate-cut expectations firm.

COOLING OFF: Technology (-4% over 5 days) and Communication Services (-1.7%). The mega-cap tech trade is exhausted after a huge run — money is rotating out of crowded names. Utilities also weak, suggesting this isn't a defensive rotation.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is leaving Big Tech and going into Energy and cyclicals — this is a "growth is priced in, value looks cheaper" rotation. Bad short-term backdrop for AAPL specifically because it's a Tech + Comm-adjacent name getting hit from both sides.

RELATED PLAY: If smart glasses are the new frontier, watch Meta (META) — they're 2 years ahead with Ray-Ban Meta glasses. And the chip suppliers (Broadcom for Apple's custom silicon, TSM for fab).

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- META (Meta Platforms): Winning the smart-glasses race that Apple is now chasing — Ray-Ban Meta is a real product with real sales.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Waymo building custom AI chips shows vertical integration paying off; also they're the one holding the \$20B search-deal card against Apple.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is lagging the AI narrative badly — Apple Intelligence has been underwhelming and now they're playing catch-up in glasses too. When Tech sector is down 4% in a week and AAPL is only mid-pack, that tells you it's neither a leader nor a safe haven right now. That's a "hold" not a "buy."

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$295-305 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: China tariff escalation hits margins >300bps, or foldable iPhone launch flops

Hedging: Buy protective puts around earnings, or pair with a China-exposure short

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$173.96 ▼ 0.70%	12M Price Target \$185.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$418.04B
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PLTR: Cluster Insider Selling Meets Rich AI Valuation

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat at \$173.96 after a monster 33%+ run over the past month — the market is digesting gains, not selling off. That sideways action tells me buyers and sellers are in a standoff at these levels, waiting for the next catalyst.
- Director Alexander Moore dumped ~\$2.8M in shares last week across four transactions — that's cluster insider selling (multiple sells in a short window), which historically is a yellow flag. Not a "sell everything" signal, but insiders know things you don't, and they're taking chips off the table near highs.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: PLTR has become the poster child for the Trump administration's "AI-first government" push, and the stock is pricing in a LOT of that already. The 33% rally in a month means expectations are sky-high — any hiccup in federal contract wins, and this thing gives back 20% fast. The options flow is technically bullish (put/call at 0.95, calls being scooped up), but that \$200 strike put buying tells me some smart money is hedging against a pullback from these nosebleed levels. Bottom line: the story is still intact, but you're paying tomorrow's price today, and insiders are quietly heading for the exits.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big tailwind: the FY2026 defense authorization and the administration's continued push on federal AI adoption — Palantir is the primary beneficiary of the Pentagon's Maven-style AI programs and has been embedded in Army, ICE, and HHS workflows. Watch the ongoing budget reconciliation debates in Congress — if defense discretionary spending gets protected (likely under this administration), PLTR's government book keeps compounding. The wildcard risk: any bipartisan pushback on government surveillance AI or civil liberties legislation could create headline risk, though the current political configuration makes major restrictions unlikely in the next 12 months.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

This is where it gets uncomfortable — PLTR trades at roughly 100x forward sales, meaning investors are paying \$100 for every \$1 of revenue the company will generate next year. For context, most software peers trade at \$10-15 per \$1 of revenue. The bull case is that PLTR grows into it via government AI dominance, but that valuation only makes sense if revenue growth stays above 30% for years — any deceleration and the multiple compresses hard.

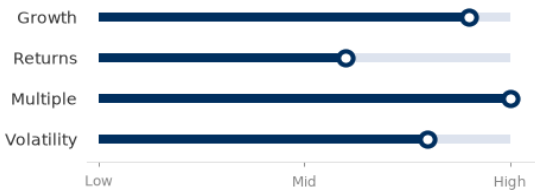
WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- Insider cluster selling near all-time highs — when directors sell \$2.8M in four days, it's rarely a coincidence with the top being in

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$173.96
12M Price Target	\$185.00
Upside / (Downside)	+6.3%
Market Cap	\$418.04B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,600M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.85
Fwd P/E	280.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$195.00	\$175.00	\$155.00
6 Months	\$220.00	\$185.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$250.00	\$195.00	\$125.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$220.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$300.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$400.00	\$75.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% this week) — likely reflecting geopolitical tension and continued fossil-fuel-friendly policy from Washington. Defense-adjacent AI still has structural tailwinds from federal spending priorities.

COOLING OFF: Technology (-4% over 5 days) and Communication Services (-1.7%) — the mega-cap tech trade is taking a breather, which is why PLTR being flat is actually relative outperformance.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating out of high-multiple tech into energy and real assets — that's a warning sign for names like PLTR that live on multiple expansion.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the government AI theme but want less valuation risk, look at defense primes with AI exposure — LMT, RTX, or infrastructure players like data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) that benefit regardless of which AI winner emerges.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- SNOW (Snowflake): The "other" agentic AI backbone getting comparison coverage — riding the same enterprise AI adoption wave but at a more digestible valuation
- Defense primes broadly (LMT, GD): Benefiting from the same federal spending tailwind as PLTR but trade at 15-20x earnings vs PLTR's stratospheric multiple

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is LEADING its peer group hard — up 33% in a month while tech sector is down 4% over 5 days. That kind of divergence usually mean-reverts. Either peers catch up, or PLTR gives some back. History says the latter is more common.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business and the policy tailwinds, but I hate the entry price here. Great company, wrong moment to chase.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% of portfolio — this is a volatile name where you want exposure but not a position that keeps you up at night. If you already own it and are up big, consider trimming 20-30% to lock in gains.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$150-160 range — that's where the stock previously consolidated before this last leg up. Buying at \$174 with insiders selling feels like chasing.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm watching is Q3/Q4 earnings and any major DoD contract announcements. Also watching FY2027 budget proposals early next year.

WHEN TO BAIL: Revenue growth drops below 25% YoY, they lose a major government contract, or the stock breaks below its 200-day moving average with volume — that would signal the momentum trade is over.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy some downside protection (put options ~10% below current price) if you're holding a full position, or just trim into strength. Don't try to short this outright; momentum names can stay irrational longer than you can stay solvent.

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy \$260.11 ▼ 2.16% 12M Price Target \$295.00 52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20

Market Cap \$2.81T

AMZN: Tariff Refunds and AI Debt Fatigue Weigh Today

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN dropped 2.16% to \$260 — this looks like it's part of a broader tech wobble (Tech ETF -4% over 5 days). The Reuters piece on "AI debt fatigue" is the real story: investors are starting to question whether hyperscalers like Amazon are borrowing too much to fund AI data centers. When the market gets nervous about AI capex, AMZN gets hit because AWS is spending tens of billions on Nvidia chips and infrastructure.
- The UPS/FedEx/DHL tariff refund story is a subtle tell — carriers are refunding customers for Trump tariffs that got rolled back or refunded. That's actually a mild positive for Amazon's logistics costs, but not enough to overcome the AI capex worry today.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's really going on: the market is having a mini-panic about how much debt Big Tech is piling on to build AI infrastructure, and AMZN is caught in that crosscurrent even though it's arguably the best positioned. Meanwhile, the CEO of Amazon's retail business (Herrington) sold ~\$1M in stock last week — not huge, but not a vote of confidence either. The bullish signal to focus on: options flow is screaming BULLISH with a 0.41 put/call ratio (meaning traders are buying 2.5x more upside bets than downside protection) and there's a massive unusual call buy at the \$120 strike — that's someone making a big long-term bet. This tells me the smart money is using the dip to accumulate, even as retail worries about AI spending.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

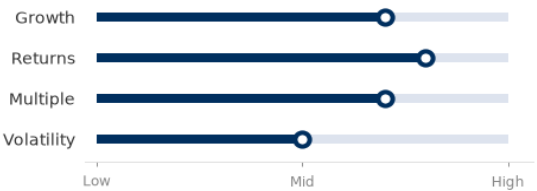
The Trump tariff situation is the biggest live wire — the news that shipping carriers are refunding tariff overpayments suggests Trump's tariff regime is getting messier and possibly walked back in spots, which is a net positive for Amazon's third-party sellers (many source from China). Watch the FTC antitrust case against Amazon — the Trump-era FTC under new leadership has signaled a lighter touch than the Khan era, which is a meaningful tailwind that isn't priced in yet. Also on the radar: any executive order on AI infrastructure/permitting for data centers — Trump has been pushing to fast-track power and land approvals, which directly benefits AWS's build-out.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$260.11
12M Price Target	\$295.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.4%
Market Cap	\$2.81T
FY2026E Revenue	\$715M
FY2027E Revenue	\$790M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.10
Fwd P/E	37.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$278.00	\$265.00	\$248.00
6 Months	\$305.00	\$280.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$330.00	\$295.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$325.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$400.00	\$250.00
10 Years	\$750.00	\$550.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% over 5 days) — this ties to Trump's "drill baby drill" agenda and rising power demand from AI data centers. Ironic tailwind: more energy demand = more AWS revenue eventually.

COOLING OFF: Tech (-4% over 5 days) and Communications (-1.7%) — the AI debt narrative is dragging the whole megacap complex.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating out of tech into energy and defensives as investors get nervous about AI ROI. This is a healthy pullback, not a regime change — the AI buildout thesis is intact.

RELATED PLAY: If AMZN's AWS thesis holds, the picks-and-shovels plays win too — think Vertiv (VRT) for data center cooling, or Constellation Energy (CEG) for the nuclear power AWS needs.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XOM (Exxon): Riding energy sector strength and Trump's fossil-fuel-friendly policies
- TSLA (Tesla): Just got Vegas robotaxi permit today — autonomous rollout momentum

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is lagging its megacap peers slightly this week, but it's actually holding up better than pure-AI names. That relative strength tells me the retail/AWS diversification is providing a floor — the stock isn't a one-trick AI pony, and that's why I'd buy this dip rather than sell it.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — high quality business at a fair price with a friendlier regulatory backdrop, but the AI capex overhang is real short-term.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% — this is a core holding, not a trade. Big enough to matter, small enough to sleep at night.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$250-258. If it breaks \$248 on macro panic, back up the truck to \$240.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is Q3 earnings showing AWS growth accelerating and Trump-era FTC signaling on the antitrust case.

WHEN TO BAIL: If AWS growth drops below 15% YoY two quarters in a row, or if a court forces an AWS spin-off, I'm out.

HEDGING: Buy a put at the \$240 strike expiring in 3-6 months — think of it as insurance that pays off if the stock craters. Costs a small premium but caps your downside.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$134.00 ▼ 4.05%	12M Price Target \$145.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.77T
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SPCX: Space ETF Dragged Down by SpaceX Unlock Selling

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX got hit for 4% today and about 8% off last week's highs — the culprit is SpaceX (the ETF's biggest holding via private shares). Another employee share unlock hit the secondary market, meaning insiders can now sell, which floods supply and pressures the price.
- A fresh sell rating on SpaceX suggesting 25% downside piled on, and separately, China announced progress on a new heavy-lift rocket — reminding investors that the US isn't the only game in town.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the thing: SPCX isn't really trading on fundamentals right now — it's trading on the marked-to-market value of SpaceX shares, which just got flooded with new supply from an employee tender. That's a technical selloff, not a business story, which usually means it's a buyable dip UNLESS the SpaceX valuation itself is reset lower. The bigger signal to watch is whether that Barron's-cited 25% downside call reflects real IPO-comp compression (Anthropic filing to go public is dragging every "unicorn" comp lower) or just one analyst's take. Bottom line: the space THEME is intact — government contracts, satellite buildout, defense — but the ETF's near-term price is being whipped around by one holding's private-market plumbing.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The FY2027 defense authorization bill is winding through Congress with Space Force funding proposed up roughly 13% — that's a direct tailwind for SPCX's defense-heavy holdings (Rocket Lab, Iridium, L3Harris exposure). Also watch the NASA Artemis budget reconciliation: the White House has signaled a lean toward commercial partners over legacy contractors, which is bullish for SpaceX and Rocket Lab. The wildcard is ITAR export rules — any tightening on satellite tech exports (in response to China's rocket progress) could squeeze the smaller sat-comms names in the ETF.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

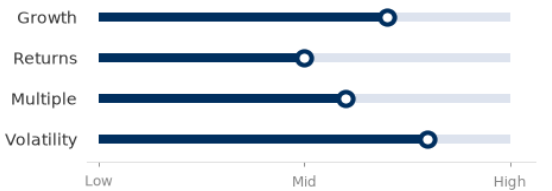
SPCX trades at roughly the midpoint of its 52-week range but well off the \$225 high — you're paying for a growth theme where most holdings aren't yet profitable, so traditional P/E doesn't apply. Think of it as paying for optionality on a decade-long space buildout, with SpaceX as the anchor. It's not "cheap" but the pullback has taken some froth out — if SpaceX's private valuation holds around \$400B, the ETF has support here.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$134.00
12M Price Target	\$145.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.2%
Market Cap	\$1.77T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$145.00	\$135.00	\$120.00
6 Months	\$165.00	\$145.00	\$115.00
1 Year	\$190.00	\$155.00	\$110.00
2 Years	\$230.00	\$175.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$320.00	\$230.00	\$130.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$350.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% this week) as oil catches a bid on Middle East tensions and expected winter demand. Defense-adjacent names are quietly strong on budget expectations.

COOLING OFF: Tech (-4% weekly) — mega-cap AI is exhaling after a huge run, and that's dragging space/growth names with it. Comm Services also weak.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating out of high-multiple growth (tech, space, AI unicorns) into hard assets and energy. That's a headwind for SPCX until the growth trade regains footing.

RELATED PLAY: If you want space exposure without the SpaceX private-share drama, look at ITA (defense ETF) or a direct name like Rocket Lab (RKLB) — cleaner exposure to the same government spending tailwind.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Neutron rocket progress and steady government contract wins — pure-play space without the private-market noise.
- LHX (L3Harris): Defense-space contractor benefiting directly from Space Force budget expansion.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging its diversified defense peers right now because it's over-indexed to SpaceX, which is caught up in unlock-driven selling. That tells me the weakness is holding-specific, not thematic — the space story is fine, this ETF just has a concentration problem playing out.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the multi-year space theme but the near-term is messy because of SpaceX unlock dynamics I can't fully predict.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this is a thematic bet, not a core holding, and volatility is high enough that you don't want to overdo it.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd start scaling in around \$125-130 if the selling continues, and add aggressively only if it touches the \$115-120 area on a broader market flush.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the real catalyst is SpaceX filing for IPO, which would remove the private-mark overhang and probably re-rate the whole ETF higher.

WHEN TO BAIL: If SpaceX gets marked down in a tender offer, or if the Space Force budget increase gets gutted in Congress — those are the two thesis-breakers.

HEDGING: Keep some dry powder to buy dips, and consider pairing with a defense ETF like ITA which gives you the same government-spending tailwind without the private-share whiplash.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy	\$95.10 ▼ 0.70%	12M Price Target \$115.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$85.50B
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HOOD: Crypto Rally + CLARITY Act Push = Real Tailwind

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD is slightly red today (-0.70%) but that's misleading — the real story is Bitcoin having its best week since 2024 after Trump met with crypto leaders and personally pushed the CLARITY Act (the big crypto market-structure bill). HOOD is a direct beneficiary because crypto trading is now ~35-40% of their transaction revenue.
- The overnight vibe is bullish for the sector, but options flow is flashing yellow — big traders bought a ton of \$115 and \$120 puts expiring this month. That's someone hedging or betting on a near-term pullback after the run from \$63 to \$95.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what to actually think about: HOOD has doubled off its 52-week low and is now sitting at 35% of its yearly range from the bottom — meaning the easy money's been made, but the setup for the NEXT leg depends almost entirely on Washington. If the CLARITY Act passes (which gives crypto exchanges clear rules on what's a security vs. a commodity), Robinhood can legally expand tokenized stocks, stablecoin yield products, and prediction markets — that's a whole new revenue stream. The unusual put buying tells me institutions think the stock is priced for perfection near-term and want protection into month-end, but they're likely still long the underlying. Translation: expect chop, but the trend is your friend if policy cooperates.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The CLARITY Act (Digital Asset Market Clarity Act) is THE bill to watch — it's stalled in Congress but Trump is now personally lobbying for it, and the administration is moving ahead with rules via executive action anyway. If it passes, HOOD gets a green light to roll out tokenized equities and expanded crypto products to US customers (they've already launched this in Europe). Also watch the SEC under the new leadership — enforcement posture has flipped from adversarial to accommodative, which is a night-and-day change from the 2023-2024 era when HOOD was getting Wells notices (formal warnings of potential SEC charges).

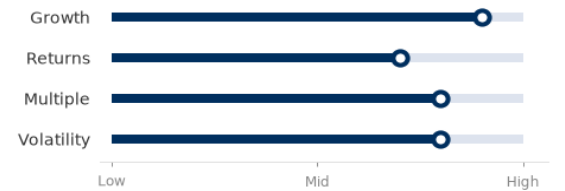
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$85B market cap and ~\$4.2B expected revenue, you're paying about \$20 for every \$1 of revenue — that's rich compared to Schwab or Interactive Brokers (~\$5-8), but HOOD is growing 30%+ vs. their single digits. On earnings, it's ~51x forward P/E (you pay \$51 for every \$1 of profit) which only makes sense if crypto revenue keeps compounding. Fair for a growth story with policy tailwinds, expensive if crypto volumes cool off.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$95.10
12M Price Target	\$115.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.9%
Market Cap	\$85.50B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,300M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.60
Fwd P/E	51.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$110.00	\$98.00	\$82.00
6 Months	\$130.00	\$108.00	\$75.00
1 Year	\$155.00	\$115.00	\$65.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$140.00	\$55.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$180.00	\$40.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$260.00	\$30.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% this week) is quietly running on the Trump admin's drill-baby-drill posture and grid demand. Crypto-adjacent financials are ripping on the CLARITY Act push even though it's not showing in the sector ETFs yet.

COOLING OFF: Tech (-4% this week) is losing steam — some rotation out of mega-cap AI names as valuations got stretched. Comm Services and Utilities also weak.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of expensive tech and INTO crypto beneficiaries and energy. HOOD sits in an unusual spot — it's technically financials but trades like crypto/tech, so it can get hit by both flows.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the crypto thesis, look at COIN (Coinbase) as the pure-play, or MSTR (Strategy, formerly MicroStrategy) which popped 10% premarket today as a Bitcoin proxy. CME Group also benefits from regulated crypto derivatives growth.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSTR (Strategy): +10% premarket — pure Bitcoin proxy, benefits directly from Trump's crypto push and the price surge.
- COIN (Coinbase): Leading the crypto exchange trade — bigger institutional exposure than HOOD, cleaner CLARITY Act beneficiary.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is participating but lagging pure crypto names today because it's a hybrid (equities + crypto + options). That's actually a feature, not a bug — it means less downside when crypto rolls over. But on days like today, expect it to underperform COIN and MSTR on the way up.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Cautiously bullish. The policy tailwind is real but the stock has already run hard, and the put flow makes me want to wait for a better entry.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio. Enough to matter if the CLARITY Act passes, small enough that a crypto drawdown doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$88-92, which is where the stock has found support recently. Chasing above \$100 into the current setup feels late.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst clock is the CLARITY Act timeline plus Q3/Q4 earnings showing crypto revenue durability.

WHEN TO BAIL: Bitcoin breaks below \$80K, CLARITY Act gets killed in Senate, or HOOD reports a quarter with crypto revenue down >30% QoQ. Any of those and I'm trimming hard.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — if you're up big, sell a third and let the rest ride. Options-savvy folks can buy \$85 puts 3 months out as cheap insurance against a crypto air pocket.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Hold	\$545.83 ▼ 0.04%	12M Price Target \$620.00	52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$790.80	Market Cap \$1.39T
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META: Near 52-Week Lows as Tech Sells Off, Insiders Exit

WHAT HAPPENED

- META just crashed from \$590 to \$545 in four sessions — that's a 7.5% drop and it's now sitting at just 9% of its 52-week range (meaning it's basically scraping the bottom of where it's traded all year). The tech sector as a whole is off 4% in five days, so this isn't just a META story — rising Treasury yields are punishing every high-growth name because when you can get 4.5%+ risk-free from bonds, expensive stocks look less attractive.
- Two red flags stacked on top: the CFO (Susan Li) sold over \$2.7M in stock on 8/18 right as the drop accelerated, and options traders are loading up on puts at \$620, \$640, \$660 strikes — those are bets that the stock stays BELOW those levels. Insiders selling + smart money buying downside protection = the pros aren't feeling great short-term.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really happening: META isn't broken, but it's caught in a nasty crossfire. The macro problem is spiking Treasury yields (the return on government bonds) — when yields rise, investors dump expensive tech and rotate to safer stuff, which is exactly what the sector ETF data shows (Energy +4.4% while Tech -4%). The company-specific problem is the teen lawsuit dismissal ahead of the October trial — while a dismissal sounds bullish, the fact that this is even a headline means the social-media-harms-kids narrative is still very much alive heading into an election-adjacent political environment where regulating Big Tech is one of the few bipartisan issues. Bottom line: the fundamentals (ad business, AI infrastructure) are fine, but sentiment and positioning are ugly, and insiders selling into weakness tells you they don't see an imminent snapback.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

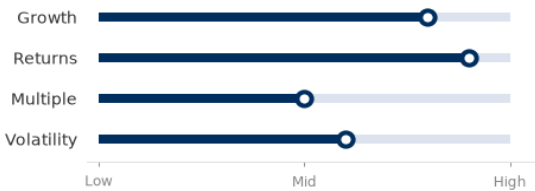
The big overhang right now is KOSA (Kids Online Safety Act) and state-level equivalents — if any version passes with teeth, META has to fundamentally rebuild how teens use Instagram, and that's the second-most-engaged demographic on the platform. Also watch the FTC's ongoing antitrust case trying to force divestiture of Instagram and WhatsApp — a ruling could come any time, and while most analysts think META wins, the tail risk is enormous. On the friendlier side: the administration's aggressive stance on Chinese apps (TikTok pressure continuing) is a massive tailwind — every hour a teen doesn't spend on TikTok is an hour Reels can monetize.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$545.83
12M Price Target	\$620.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.6%
Market Cap	\$1.39T
FY2026E Revenue	\$197M
FY2027E Revenue	\$225M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	19.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$590.00	\$560.00	\$510.00
6 Months	\$680.00	\$610.00	\$480.00
1 Year	\$750.00	\$620.00	\$450.00
2 Years	\$900.00	\$700.00	\$420.00
5 Years	\$1200.00	\$850.00	\$380.00
10 Years	\$2000.00	\$1200.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% in 5 days) — this is a yield/inflation story; when rates rise and oil holds firm, energy wins. Real Estate holding up on rate-cut speculation.

COOLING OFF: Technology (-4%) and Communication Services (-1.7%, META's actual sector) — classic duration selloff, meaning long-duration growth stocks get hit hardest when discount rates rise.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is fleeing high-multiple tech into cyclical and yield plays ahead of Nvidia earnings — everyone's positioning defensively in case NVDA disappoints and takes the whole AI trade down.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe META specifically gets bought here, GOOGL is trading at a similar discount with less regulatory hair, and Trade Desk (TTD) is a pure-play ad-tech name that benefits from the same digital ad tailwind without the antitrust drama.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XOM (Exxon): Energy leading as oil holds and yields rise — pure macro rotation trade
- AVGO (Broadcom): Getting bought on the AI-infrastructure dip; analysts calling it the "picks and shovels" AI play with better margins than Nvidia

META CONTEXT: META is LAGGING badly — down 7.5% in a week while the broader tech ETF is only off 4%, meaning it's underperforming its own sector. That's a yellow flag; when a name gets sold harder than its peers, either something specific is wrong or it's simply where hedge funds are trimming winners. Given insider selling patterns, I lean toward the latter — profit-taking after a huge run, not a fundamental break.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$520-535 range

Time Horizon: 12-18 months

Thesis Invalidation: Ad revenue growth slows below 10% YoY or major EU/US antitrust ruling forces divestiture

Hedging: Buy Sep puts at \$520 strike or pair with short GOOGL

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$974.33 ▲ 3.97%	12M Price Target \$1150.00	52-Week Range \$114.25 – \$1255.00	Market Cap N/A
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MU: AI Memory Demand Explodes, CHIPS Act Still Paying

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU bounced back +3.97% to \$974 after two ugly down days — the CEO Sanjay Mehrotra went on the tape saying AI has "fundamentally changed" memory demand, which is Wall Street code for "we can raise prices and nobody can stop us." That's the kind of comment that makes hedge funds re-add positions they trimmed on Monday.
- The Waymo "building its own AI chip" headline is a nothingburger for MU — Waymo still needs memory around whatever custom chip they build, and MU sells the memory, not the logic chip. Market seems to have figured that out.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- A US-China trade thaw would be bad news — if Washington cuts a deal that lets Chinese memory maker CXMT access Western equipment, the whole industry gets flooded with cheap supply within 18 months.
- Insider "OTHER" transactions on 8/10 look weird — those names (Schneider, Farmer, Garula) don't match MU's actual executive team, so this might be a data error in the feed, but worth flagging that the ticker mapping looks off. Real risk: if actual MU insiders are selling into strength, that's a yellow flag.
- The non-obvious risk: hyperscalers (Microsoft, Meta, Google) are all trying to design their own memory controllers and could eventually squeeze MU's margins by dual-sourcing more aggressively — this is a 2027+ concern but it's building.

IN THE NEWS

Waymo is making its own AI chip for its robotaxi service Yahoo Finance Video · 2026-08-20 19:43

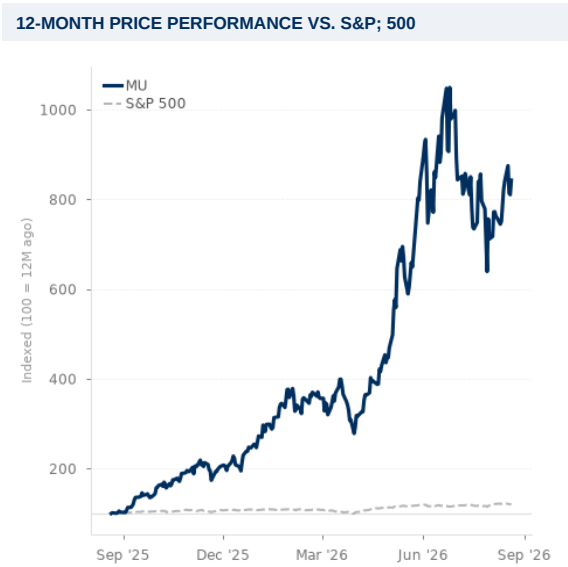
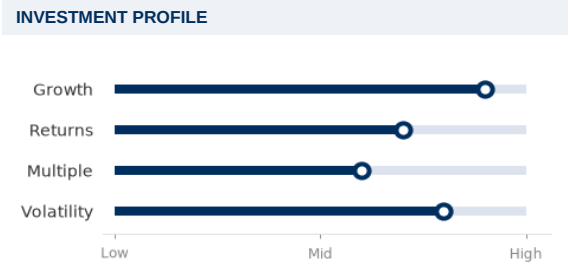
Think It's Too Late to Buy Micron? Here's the Case for Getting In Now. 24/7 Wall St. · 2026-08-21 13:05

Micron CEO Delivers Blunt Message For Stock Investors GuruFocus.com · 2026-08-21 12:19

Micron's AI Demand Problem Is a Good One GuruFocus.com · 2026-08-21 12:11

Micron CEO Sanjay Mehrotra says AI has changed memory demand Quartz · 2026-08-21 12:03

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$974.33
12M Price Target	\$1150.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.0%
Market Cap	N/A
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$19.50
Fwd P/E	68.6x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1100.00	\$1000.00	\$900.00
6 Months	\$1300.00	\$1150.00	\$850.00
1 Year	\$1500.00	\$1200.00	\$800.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1400.00	\$700.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1700.00	\$600.00
10 Years	\$3500.00	\$2200.00	\$500.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% on the week) — likely reflects higher power demand narrative tied to data centers, which circles back to AI. Materials holding up too.

COOLING OFF: Technology down 4% on the week — this is a rate-driven selloff, not a fundamental one. Treasury yields spiked and long-duration growth stocks got hit. MU held up better than the sector, which is telling.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of high-multiple software and INTO "picks and shovels" AI hardware — MU, NVDA, and power/utility infrastructure names. That's a direct tailwind.

RELATED PLAY: If MU keeps running, look at Lam Research (LRCX) and Applied Materials (AMAT) — they sell the equipment MU uses to build HBM, and they benefit from every fab expansion CHIPS Act funds.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the reference point for AI hardware — every dollar of Nvidia GPU sold pulls MU HBM with it.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning on custom AI silicon for hyperscalers, which is bearish for Nvidia at the margin but neutral-to-positive for MU (still needs memory).

MU CONTEXT: MU is roughly keeping pace with NVDA on a 1-year basis but with more volatility — the fact that it bounced +4% today while tech ETF was flat means MU-specific news (CEO comments) is outweighing macro. That's a bullish tell: single-stock alpha is showing up.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — pounding the table with one hand, keeping the other on the eject button because memory cycles always end eventually.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — enough to matter, not enough to blow you up if the cycle turns.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$920-950. If it flushes to \$850 on a macro panic day, that's a fat pitch.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst is HBM4 ramp in 2027 and continued CHIPS Act funding disbursements.

WHEN TO BAIL: If MU guides revenue down for two consecutive quarters, or if there's a real US-China chip trade deal that lets China back into the advanced memory market, cut it.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a put option 10-15% below current price expiring 3-6 months out. Think of it as insurance: costs you a couple percent, protects you against a memory cycle top or a black swan trade deal.

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$345.13 ▼ 1.71%	12M Price Target \$380.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.36T
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TSLA: Robotaxi Wins Offset By China Recall Drama

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock down 1.7% and the tape is messy — Tesla just got Vegas robotaxi permits (big deal, real revenue path) AND is recalling nearly 3 million cars in China over door latches that can trap people. The market is basically saying "cool future, ugly present." Net negative today because China is 20%+ of deliveries and this recall lands right as BYD is eating their lunch there.
- Also got hit with a \$243M judgment because a bug bounty hacker proved Tesla lied about Autopilot crash data existing. That's not the dollar amount that matters — it's the precedent for the ~15 other Autopilot lawsuits in the pipeline.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one: the federal \$7,500 EV tax credit officially sunset last fall under the current administration's rollback, and Tesla has been absorbing that hit in margins all year — every quarter without it is a quarter of proof they can survive on their own. Watch the NHTSA — they're actively investigating FSD after several high-profile incidents, and any formal restriction on Level 3+ autonomy would gut the robotaxi thesis that's holding this multiple up. On the flip side, the administration's push to fast-track autonomous vehicle federal preemption (overriding state-by-state rules) would be a massive tailwind — Tesla can't scale robotaxi city-by-city forever.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$1.36T market cap, you're paying roughly 147x forward earnings — meaning investors are shelling out \$147 for every \$1 of profit Tesla makes next year, versus about 8x for Ford and GM. That's not a car company multiple; that's a bet that robotaxi and Optimus become real businesses. The problem: at 24% of the 52-week range, the stock is already pricing in a lot of disappointment, so the risk/reward is more balanced than it looks — but the multiple only makes sense if you believe FSD scales in the next 18 months.

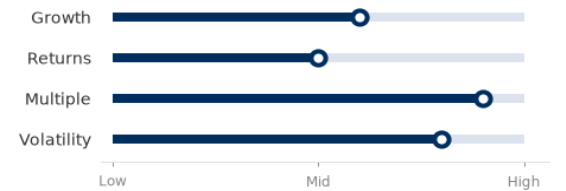
WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- China recall + BYD's price war means Tesla's second-biggest market could see delivery declines accelerate — and that's the cash cow funding all the AI moonshots
- NHTSA or a state AG cracking down on FSD/Autopilot after the \$243M judgment sets a precedent that opens the litigation floodgates

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$345.13
12M Price Target	\$380.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.1%
Market Cap	\$1.36T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$128M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.35
FY2027E EPS	\$3.10
Fwd P/E	147.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$375.00	\$350.00	\$315.00
6 Months	\$450.00	\$380.00	\$290.00
1 Year	\$520.00	\$400.00	\$275.00
2 Years	\$650.00	\$450.00	\$240.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$700.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% this week) is ripping on the administration's drill-baby-drill posture and rising crude — ironic headwind for EVs since cheap gas hurts EV demand. Bitcoin past \$77K is also lifting risk assets pre-market.

COOLING OFF: Tech (-4% on the week) and Comms Services are getting hit as rates stay sticky and the AI trade cools after a summer melt-up. Tesla is caught between "car stock" and "tech stock" and neither bucket is helping right now.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating out of high-multiple tech into energy and cyclical — that's a direct headwind for TSLA because it trades on multiple, not fundamentals. Until tech reclaims leadership, TSLA has an uphill fight.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the robotaxi story, the LiDAR and sensor names (even though Tesla doesn't use LiDAR) benefit from Waymo/Uber expansion — MBLY (Mobileye) is the cleaner autonomy pure-play if you want the theme without Tesla-specific risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- BYDDY (BYD): Eating Tesla's lunch in China and expanding into Europe — cheaper cars, better local relationships, and now Tesla's recall hands them another marketing gift
- GOOGL (Alphabet/Waymo): Got the same Vegas permit but with a longer autonomy track record — the market trusts Waymo's tech more than FSD right now

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is lagging both the broader auto space AND the AI cohort — that's the worst of both worlds and tells me the market is in "show me" mode. Until Q3 deliveries or a robotaxi milestone hits, expect it to trade heavy.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the long-term AI story but the near-term setup is unfavorable with China deteriorating and options flow flashing yellow.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this thing swings 5%+ on random days, so size it where a bad week doesn't ruin your month.

ENTRY POINTS: \$310-325 is where I'd add — that's near the 52-week low support and offers real margin of safety. Chasing at \$345 with put buyers this aggressive feels premature.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — you need at least a year for robotaxi to scale enough to justify the multiple. The catalyst I'm waiting for is Vegas robotaxi launch metrics and Q4 China delivery numbers.

WHEN TO BAIL: NHTSA opens a formal FSD enforcement action, or China deliveries drop 20%+ YoY for two straight quarters. Either one and the thesis is broken.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — own a smaller position and keep dry powder. If you want protection, buying 6-month puts around \$300 is cheap insurance given how much this stock can drop on bad news.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$216.85 ▼ 0.33%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.25T
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NVDA: Cooling Into Earnings, But Policy Winds Still Blow

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is drifting lower for the fifth straight day (down ~3.7% from Aug 14) heading into earnings next week — this is classic pre-earnings de-risking. Big money is trimming so they don't get caught offside if the print disappoints. Nothing broken here, just nerves.
- Nvidia's reportedly in talks to invest in Cloverleaf Infrastructure (a data center power/land developer) — this matters because power, not chips, is now the actual bottleneck for AI. NVDA is quietly buying into the whole stack.

WHY IT MATTERS

The setup into earnings is interesting: options flow shows heavy call buying at \$217.5 (traders betting on a bounce) but also unusual put buying at \$227.5 and \$237.5 — meaning smart money is hedging the upside, not the downside. Translation: the market thinks earnings will be fine but is skeptical of a monster rally from here. The Cloverleaf move tells you management sees power/grid capacity as the real constraint on their growth — that's a strategic tell that the AI buildout has a longer runway than skeptics (like Chamath calling it a bubble) think. If you're long, the Chamath "945% run, zero to do with real earnings" narrative is the sentiment risk you're fighting — but the numbers keep proving it wrong quarter after quarter.

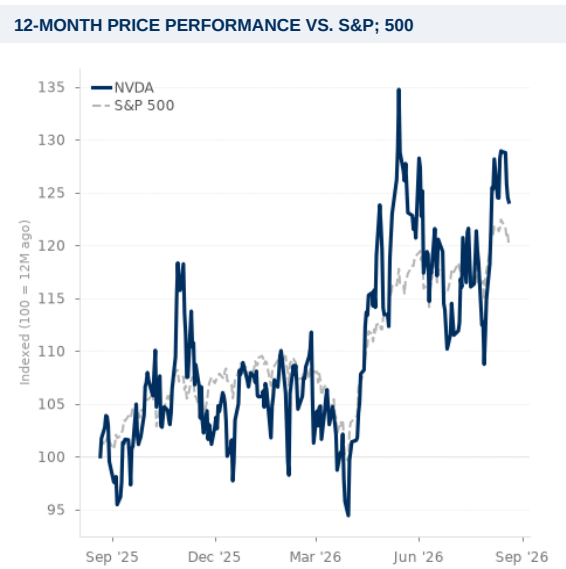
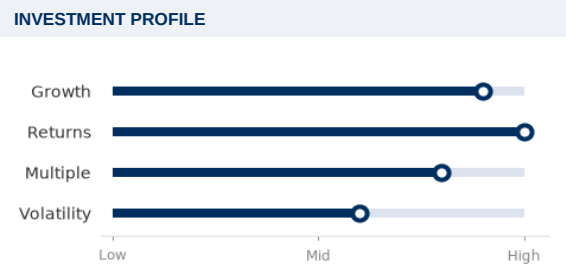
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The biggest live policy issue is the ongoing China export licensing regime — the Trump administration cut a deal earlier this year letting NVDA sell H20 chips to China in exchange for a 15% revenue cut to the US Treasury, which is unprecedented and could get challenged in court. Watch for any expansion of restrictions to Blackwell-class chips, which would immediately hit ~13% of revenue. On the tailwind side, the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and the administration's "AI Action Plan" continue to push federal AI infrastructure spending — every new federal AI contract flows through NVDA silicon, directly or indirectly.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$5.25T market cap and roughly 49x forward earnings, you're paying \$49 for every \$1 of profit expected next year — expensive vs the S&P at ~22x, but cheap if you believe FY27 revenue hits \$265B+ (that would make it more like 35x). The real question isn't the multiple, it's whether data center growth can stay above 40% YoY — as long as it does, the valuation prints itself into reasonableness. If growth cracks to sub-25%, the multiple compresses hard and this becomes a \$170 stock fast.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$216.85
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+19.9%
Market Cap	\$5.25T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$265M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.45
FY2027E EPS	\$6.10
Fwd P/E	48.7x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$222.00	\$205.00
6 Months	\$265.00	\$240.00	\$190.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$260.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$360.00	\$300.00	\$170.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$380.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$750.00	\$500.00	\$220.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% this week) — this is directly tied to AI power demand and the administration's push for more domestic energy production; nuclear and natgas names are the sleeper AI trade

COOLING OFF: Tech (-4% week), Comm Services (-1.7%) — profit taking after a huge run, plus the market's getting antsy about AI capex sustainability

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving from mega-cap tech into energy and real assets — investors are essentially playing the "AI needs power" second-order trade rather than chasing NVDA at all-time highs

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI story, the power infrastructure names (Vistra, Constellation, GE Vernova) and the cooling/data center REITs (Digital Realty, Equinix) are the picks-and-shovels-to-the-picks-and-shovels play

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning on custom AI silicon for hyperscalers — the "not NVDA" AI trade that's working
- VST (Vistra Energy): Nuclear + gas power for data centers, up huge as the power bottleneck narrative takes hold

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is lagging its own peer group this week as the market rotates within AI rather than out of it — that's actually healthy, not bearish. When the whole complex sells off together, that's when you worry. Right now it just looks like pre-earnings positioning.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — the fundamental story is still intact and the policy environment is net-friendly, but earnings next week creates binary short-term risk

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% as a core AI holding — big enough to matter, small enough that a bad China headline doesn't wreck your year

ENTRY POINTS: The \$210-217 zone right now is reasonable; if it dips to \$200 on earnings jitters or a macro flush, back up the truck

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst you're waiting for is the Blackwell Ultra ramp showing up in Q4/Q1 numbers and the FY27 data center guide

WHEN TO BAIL: Data center growth drops below 30% YoY, OR China export controls expand to Blackwell, OR any hyperscaler cuts 2027 capex guidance

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is buying Sept or Oct \$200 puts before earnings — costs about 1.5% of your position but caps your downside if the print disappoints; alternatively, trim 20% of the position into the print and buy it back after

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$340.67 ▼ 1.17%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$201.30 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.17T
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GOOGL: Waymo Chip Play Meets Robotaxi Green Light

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock dipped 1.17% yesterday, but this looks like sector sympathy pain — Tech ETF is down 4% over 5 days and Communication Services is off 1.66%. GOOGL isn't being singled out; the whole tech complex is cooling as money rotates to energy (+4.4% on the week).
- Two Waymo catalysts overnight that the market is undervaluing: Vegas robotaxi permits granted (alongside Tesla and Uber), AND Waymo is designing its own AI chip in-house. Translation — they're building a vertically integrated robotaxi stack like Tesla, which could dramatically improve unit economics long term.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Waymo custom-chip news is a bigger deal than the tape suggests. Building your own silicon means Alphabet is telling the world Waymo is a real business with a 10-year roadmap, not a science project — and it cuts NVIDIA out of the bill of materials, which is how you get to profitable robotaxi economics. Combined with Vegas permits (a top-5 US ride-hail market), Waymo is quietly becoming a "sum-of-the-parts" catalyst that could force analysts to assign it real value instead of a rounding error. The bearish put flow at \$370-\$390 strikes tells me institutions are hedging near-term downside into month-end, not making a directional bet — that's protection, not conviction selling.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big overhang is still the DOJ antitrust remedy phase on Search — the government wants Chrome divested and default-search deals unwound. Watch for the final remedy ruling; if it lands softer than feared (behavioral remedies vs. structural breakup), GOOGL rerates higher by 10-15% overnight. Separately, the teen social-media lawsuit dismissal ahead of the October trial is a small win — it suggests the courts are getting more skeptical of the "platforms harm kids" theory, which reduces regulatory tail risk for YouTube. Federal AI executive orders continue to favor large, compliant incumbents like Google over startups — that's a quiet moat.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~35x forward earnings (you're paying \$35 for every \$1 of profit expected next year), GOOGL is priced in line with the S&P tech average but cheaper than Microsoft (~38x) and Meta (~36x) despite arguably better AI infrastructure. The \$4.17T market cap already prices in Search + Cloud + YouTube — Waymo and Gemini upside are essentially free options. Not a screaming bargain, but reasonable given 12-15% earnings growth and the antitrust cloud starting to lift.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

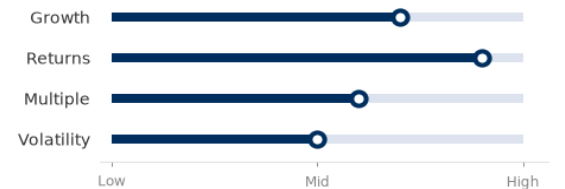
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-21 13:26 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$340.67
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.0%
Market Cap	\$4.17T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	34.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$360.00	\$345.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$370.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$440.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$520.00	\$430.00	\$270.00
5 Years	\$750.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% weekly) — commodity strength and geopolitical premium. Real Estate quietly firming on rate-cut expectations.

COOLING OFF: Tech (-4% weekly) and Comm Services (-1.7%) — classic late-summer rotation out of crowded winners. Utilities weak too, suggesting it's not a defensive rotation but a risk-on shift to cyclical.

ROTATION WATCH: Money leaving mega-cap tech and flowing to energy and cyclical — this is a tactical rotation, not a regime change. When Fed cuts land, tech tends to bounce back hard.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the Waymo thesis, the data-center and custom-silicon supply chain benefits — think Broadcom (AVGO) which co-designs custom chips, or Vertiv (VRT) for cooling infrastructure.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- XOM (Exxon): Riding the energy tape, not comparable but showing where money went this week.
- META (Meta Platforms): Holding up better than GOOGL in the tech selloff — investors see less regulatory overhang and cleaner AI monetization via ad targeting.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is roughly middle-of-the-pack in Mag 7 this month — not leading, not lagging. That's actually fine given the antitrust overhang; the stock is coiling near \$340 waiting for a catalyst (DOJ ruling, earnings, Waymo milestone). When it moves, it'll move fast.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — solid setup with real optionality, but antitrust and AI-search disruption keep me from pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% — this is a core large-cap holding, not a swing trade. Sized to matter but not to hurt if DOJ surprises to the downside.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$330-340 (current zone is fine for starters). If we get a broader tech washout to \$310-315, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — catalysts are the DOJ final remedy, Waymo revenue disclosures, and Cloud margin expansion.

WHEN TO BAIL: Search revenue prints negative YoY, or DOJ orders a Chrome divestiture, or Waymo announces a major setback.

HEDGING: Buy September \$325 puts as insurance into the DOJ ruling — costs a small premium but caps your downside if the ruling goes badly. Or just keep dry powder to buy the dip.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy

\$251.01 ▲ 5.79%

12M Price Target
\$285.00

52-Week Range
\$61.44 – \$329.88

Market Cap
\$225.29B

MRVL: Google Warrant Deal Reshapes The AI Chip Story

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL popped almost 6% Wednesday and it's really about two things: (1) a wave of bullish analyst calls ahead of earnings, and (2) the market digesting that Google warrant — basically Google got the right to buy MRVL stock at a set price, but it only fully "vests" (kicks in) if Google buys \$120 BILLION worth of Marvell chips over time. That's a massive committed customer.
- Options traders piled into September \$240 and \$280 calls at 2x normal volume — that's professional money betting the stock goes higher into earnings, not a retail meme move.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Google warrant is the real story here — it essentially turns Google into a strategic partner with skin in the game, and \$120B is a number that would transform Marvell's revenue trajectory if even half of it hits. This probably means the market is starting to re-rate MRVL from "generic chip supplier" to "custom AI silicon platform for hyperscalers" (the giant cloud companies like Google, Amazon, Microsoft). Watch for earnings next week — with the stock at 71% of its 52-week range and coming off a \$216 low just three days ago, expectations are climbing fast, which cuts both ways. The Moderna short squeeze headline is worth noting too: it "upended the AI chip trade," meaning some fast money got flushed out of AI names recently, and MRVL bouncing back so hard suggests real buyers stepped in on the dip.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

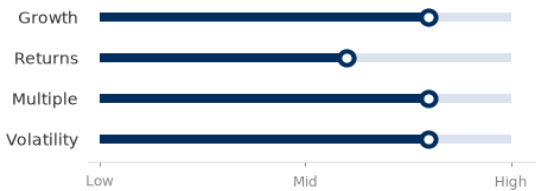
The big policy tailwind is still the CHIPS Act implementation and the Trump administration's push to keep advanced chip design in the US — Marvell designs its chips domestically (manufacturing is TSMC), so it benefits from federal preference without the fab-buildout risk. Watch the ongoing US-China export control updates: tighter restrictions on selling advanced chips to China actually help MRVL's Western hyperscaler business but could hurt a small slice of their networking revenue. Also keep an eye on any AI infrastructure spending provisions in the fall appropriations fight — federal data center buildouts (DOE, DOD) increasingly use custom silicon, which is Marvell's sweet spot.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$251.01
12M Price Target	\$285.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.5%
Market Cap	\$225.29B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$11,500M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.40
Fwd P/E	73.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$275.00	\$258.00	\$225.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$275.00	\$210.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$285.00	\$195.00
2 Years	\$420.00	\$330.00	\$180.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$425.00	\$175.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4.4% this week) is running on data center power demand — a direct read-through that AI infrastructure buildout is accelerating, which is bullish for chip designers like MRVL.

COOLING OFF: Broader Technology is down 4% this week, meaning MRVL's rally is stock-specific (Google deal + earnings setup) rather than a sector wave — that's actually a stronger signal than a rising-tide rally.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of generic tech and INTO picks-and-shovels AI (power, custom silicon, cooling) — MRVL sits right in that sweet spot.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI capex story, the power and cooling names (Vertiv, GE Vernova) and data center REITs (Equinix, Digital Realty) are the second-order beneficiaries — they get paid regardless of which chip company wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): The blueprint for MRVL — custom AI silicon for hyperscalers has driven a massive re-rating, and analysts are now applying that framework to Marvell.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the reference stock for AI demand — as long as Nvidia guides strong, it validates the whole ecosystem MRVL sells into.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is playing catch-up to AVGO in the custom-silicon narrative but has more room to run because it's earlier in the story. The Google warrant is Marvell's "Broadcom moment" — if the market fully buys the comparison, there's meaningful multiple expansion left.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Bullish on the setup and the Google deal, but earnings next week is a real event risk and the stock's already run hard.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — high-quality name but too volatile and event-driven to make it a core holding.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd rather add on pullbacks to \$225-235 than chase here at \$251 — with 44M shares traded on the 19th, there's plenty of volatility to give you a better entry.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst you're waiting for is Google chip shipment data showing the warrant deal is actually converting to revenue.

WHEN TO BAIL: If earnings guidance disappoints AND the stock breaks \$210, the story has cracked. Also bail if Google publicly pivots more aggressively toward in-house TPU-only strategy.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just buying a put option on MRVL through earnings — think of it as insurance that pays off if the stock crashes. Or pair it with a short in a more expensive AI name so you're betting on MRVL specifically rather than the whole sector going up.

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.9/10	BUY	
Price: \$141.37 · 1M: +34.7% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$17.7B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
2	MDB	MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	BUY	
Price: \$420.37 · 1M: +36.6% · P/S: 13.0x · Cap: \$33.8B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$410 entry					
3	BAH	Booz Allen Hamilton Holding Co. Defense Technology	8.5/10	BUY	
Price: \$76.36 · 1M: +20.5% · P/S: 0.8x · Cap: \$9.2B			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					
4	GTLB	GitLab Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.2/10	BUY	
Price: \$42.08 · 1M: +28.1% · P/S: 7.1x · Cap: \$7.1B			OPT:NEUT	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Monitor for pullback to \$50 entry					
5	HII	Huntington Ingalls Industries, Inc. Defense Technology	7.7/10	BUY	
Price: \$301.40 · 1M: +12.1% · P/S: 0.9x · Cap: \$11.9B			OPT:NEUT	INS:NEUT	INST:BULL
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt					